PERF-03 | Therapist only - all age groups

Fear of mistakes and their meaning

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Separate a specific mistake, a possible outcome and the meaning the person gives it about themselves. Explore expected criticism without promising mistakes are always received well or tying worth to one performance.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not minimize real consequences, claim an unsafe environment is safe or request a deliberate mistake. Harm, humiliation and punishment require exploration and support, not only changes to the harmed person's interpretation.

Reusing existing material

Core-04 covers interpretation, and SELF-04 responses to criticism. Here the discussion focuses on the meaning of one mistake and a possible response. Refer to existing maps where helpful.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Ido fears that a typo in an invitation will prove he cannot organize anything. The discussion separates correcting the date from a sweeping conclusion about his ability.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What possible mistake is on my mind now?

2 | Question for discussion

What practical outcome do I expect from it?

3 | Question for discussion

What personal meaning am I adding to the outcome?

4 | Question for discussion

What supports the expectation, and what is still unknown?

5 | Question for discussion

How can I respond to a mistake without defining myself by it?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If the fear relates to expected humiliation, focus on support and protection. If repeated seeking of absolute certainty develops, explore that process instead of offering more guarantees.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

A small mistake can be drawn and described simply. Distinguish a mistake from a harmful label; adults are responsible for protection from harm.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Explore exposure to criticism or online sharing. Do not treat real peer pressure as merely an irrational thought.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Distinguish responsibility for professional correction from generalizations about personal worth. A hypothetical mistake can be discussed without disclosing confidential information.

OA | Older adults

Do not infer declining ability from one error. New or persistent changes in functioning require appropriate assessment separately from this sheet.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose one specific opportunity together, only if it suits the person. Clarify binding requirements and what cannot change. The idea can be explored through conversation alone. Do not set a quota for mistakes, compromise safety or require proof of personal worth.

At the next session

Check whether facts, predictions and self-judgment could be distinguished. Learning may mean recognizing a support need; a positive thought is not required.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.cci.health.wa.gov.au/Resources/Looking-After-Yourself/Perfectionism

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